08-15

old of dubious reliability, they were also subject to contamination from other accounts the witnesses may have been exposed to. Though there had always been skeptics who had many objections to the plausibility of these accounts, it was not until the mid nineteen nineties that a strong

08-16

counter-argument to the presence of aliens was widely publicized. The General Accounting Office launched an inquiry and directed the Office of the Secretary of the Air Force to conduct an internal investigation. The result was summarized in two reports. The first, released in nineteen ninety-five,

08-17

concluded that the reported recovered material in nineteen forty-seven was likely debris from a secret government program called Project Mogul, which involved high altitude balloons meant to detect sound waves generated by Soviet atomic bomb tests and ballistic missiles. The second

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report, released two years later, in nineteen ninety-seven, concluded that reports of recovered alien bodies were likely a combination of: innocently transformed memories of military accidents involving injured or killed personnel; innocently transformed memories of the recovery of

08-19

anthropomorphic dummies in military programs US conducted in the nineteen fifties; and hoaxes that various witnesses and UFO proponents perpetrated. The psychological effects of time compression and confusion about when events occurred explained the discrepancy with the years in question. In January nineteen

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ninety-seven, Karl Pflock, one of the more prominent pro-UFO researchers, said: "Based on my research and that of others, I'm as certain as it's possible to be without absolute proof, that no flying saucer or saucers crashed in the general vicinity of Roswell or on the Plains

08-21

of San Agustin in nineteen forty-seven." He then added: "The debris found was the remains of something very earthly, all but certainly something from the Top Secret Project Mogul." Although most now agree with this conclusion, each year, during July Fourth Weekend, the City of Roswell hosts the

08-22

Roswell UFO Festival celebrating all things UFO featuring prominent UFOlogists and discussions.

09-01

Tulip mania was a period in the Dutch Golden Age during which contract prices for bulbs of the recently introduced tulip reached extraordinarily high levels and then suddenly collapsed. At the peak of tulip mania in February sixteen thirty-seven, tulip contracts sold for more than ten

09-02

times the annual income of a skilled craftsman. It is generally considered the first recorded economic bubble. The tulip, introduced to Europe in the mid sixteenth century from the Ottoman Empire, became very popular in the United Provinces, which we now know as the Netherlands. Tulip cultivation in the

08-05

the same day, the Commanding General of the Eighth Air Force stated that, in fact, a weather balloon had been recovered by the Roswell Army Air Field personnel, rather than a "flying saucer." A subsequent press conference was called, featuring debris from the crashed object that confirmed the weather

08-06

balloon description. The case was quickly forgotten and almost completely ignored, even by UFO researchers, for more than thirty years. Then;1in nineteen seventy-eight, nuclear physicist and author Stanton Friedman interviewed Jesse Marcel, the only person known to have accompanied the Roswell

08-07

debris from where it was recovered to Fort Worth. Over the next few years, the account she and others gave elevated Roswell from a forgotten incident to perhaps the most famous UFO case of all time. By the early nineteen nineties, UFO researchers had interviewed several hundred

08-08

people who had, or who claimed to have had, a connection with the events at Roswell in nineteen forty-seven. Additionally, hundreds of documents were obtained by Freedom of Information Act requests, as were some that insiders apparently leaked. Their conclusions were that at least one alien craft had crashed in the Roswell

08-09

vicinity, that aliens, some possibly still alive, were recovered, and that a massive cover-up of any knowledge of the incident was put in place. Numerous books, articles, television specials and even a made-for-TV movie brought the nineteen forty-seven incident fame and notoriety so that by

08-10

the mid nineteen nineties, strong majorities in polls, such as a nineteen ninety seven CNN/Time poll, believed that aliens had visited earth and specifically that aliens had landed at Roswell and the government was covering up the fact. During the nineteen eighties and nineteen nineties, a new

08-11

narrative emerged which was at strong odds with what was reported in nineteen forty seven. This narrative evolved over the years from the time the first book on Roswell was published in nineteen eight as many new witnesses and accounts emerged, drawn out in part by the publicity on the incident. Of the hundreds of witnesses that the

08-12

various researchers interviewed - a seemingly impressive figure - a comparable few were true "witnesses" who claimed to have actually seen debris or aliens. Most of these so-called witnesses were repeating the claims of others, and their testimony would be inadmissible hearsay in an American court. As for the

08-13

several accounts from those who claimed to have seen aliens, critics identified a variety of problems with them. These problems ranged from the reliability of second-hand accounts, to serious credibility problems with witnesses making demonstrably false or internally inconsistent claims, to

08-14

dubious death-bed "confessions" or accounts from elderly or easily confused witnesses. A basic problem with all the witness accounts, according to the critics, is that they all came a minimum of thirty-one years after the events in question, and in many cases were recounted more than forty years after the fact. Not only are memories this

07-12

Lucy, announced by her sister to the audience, was all nerves as she walked out onto the middle of the stage where there was nothing but a microphone and her. She heard the audience applaud and could feel a sense of anticipation emanate from the other side of the heavy curtain. As the curtains began to part, she cast a

07-13

worried look at Jill in the wings, who assured her with a positive thumbs up. Lucy thought to herself that she could not go through with this and that she, unlike her older sister, was not confident enough to put herself before the judging audience. The crowd looked up at her and Lucy was ready to run when the first notes of the music sounded out and a sudden

07-14

calm settled over her. She closed her eyes and shut everything out, including the audience, the nerves that threatened to take over, the text messages, and the way they made her feel. It was just her and the music, and it was a love story that had been going on her whole life. She began to sing, and all

07-15

the pain and confusion that the messages had been causing inside her just flowed out. The words were not important, for it was the feeling behind them that she latched onto. Lucy was in the heart of the song with the rest of the world slipping away. When the song finished and the last note died away, she opened her eyes. To see the

07-16

whole audience on their feet and the hall filled with cheers and applause was not what Lucy had expected. Lucy allowed herself to enjoy the sense of achievement and belonging that she had not felt in a very long time. Then she saw her mother, who was cheering the loudest of all in the crowd, and Jill, who was beaming at her with pride from the wings.

07-17

She knew she owed them big time for reminding her what she was capable of and who she really was. The next time her phone bleeped she would tap the message straight into oblivion where it belonged.

08-01

The Roswell UFO Incident was the alleged recovery of extra-terrestrial debris, including alien corpses, from an object that crashed near Roswell, New Mexico, on or about July eighth, nineteen forty-seven. Since the late nineteen seventies, the incident has been the subject

08-02

of intense controversy and the subject of conspiracy theories as to the true nature of the object that crashed. The United States military maintains the debris recovered was froman experimental high-altitude surveillance balloon that belonged to a classified program named "Mogul".

08-03

However, many UFO proponents maintain that, in fact, a crashed alien craft and bodies were recovered, and that the military then engaged in a cover-up. The incident has turned into a widely known pop culture phenomenon, making the name Roswell synonymous with UFOs. It ranks as one of the most

08-04

publicized and controversial alleged UFO incidents. On July ninth, nineteen forty-seven, a press release that Roswell Army Air Field issued stated that personnel from the field's Bomb Group had recovered a crashed "flying disc" from a ranch near Roswell, sparking intense media interest. Later